The Midnight Tour : OSINT - Medium

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Description

A Halloween OSINT challenge built around the website of a fake haunted attraction, Hollow Creek Haunted Trail. The player has to track down the night guide's gate password by chaining together standard OSINT moves: robots.txt, a guestbook that only renders in a real browser, a voicemail on the site's hotline, GPS data in the EXIF of a staff photo, and a careful count in a gallery photo. The gate check runs server-side, so the flag never appears in page source.

The challenge is built to be easier for a person than for an AI. The key clue is audio only with no transcript, the count depends on a lit-vs-unlit distinction that vision models get wrong, the guestbook is invisible to raw fetches, and three visually hidden "note to AI assistants" paragraphs plant a fake flag, a fake count and a fake password.

Github Path: Capture_The_Flame_2027/OSINT/Midnight_Tour

Prompt

Every October, Hollow Creek Haunted Trail runs a Midnight Tour. It isn't on the schedule, it isn't on the map, and you need a password to get through the gate. The night guide knows it. Find them.

Start here: http://<host>:8000

Flag format: flame{...}

Hints

1. Not everything on a site is linked from the menu. Check where the site tells crawlers **not** to go.
2. The hotline menu only lists three options, but the keypad has twelve buttons. Someone on the crew page knows which extension to dial.

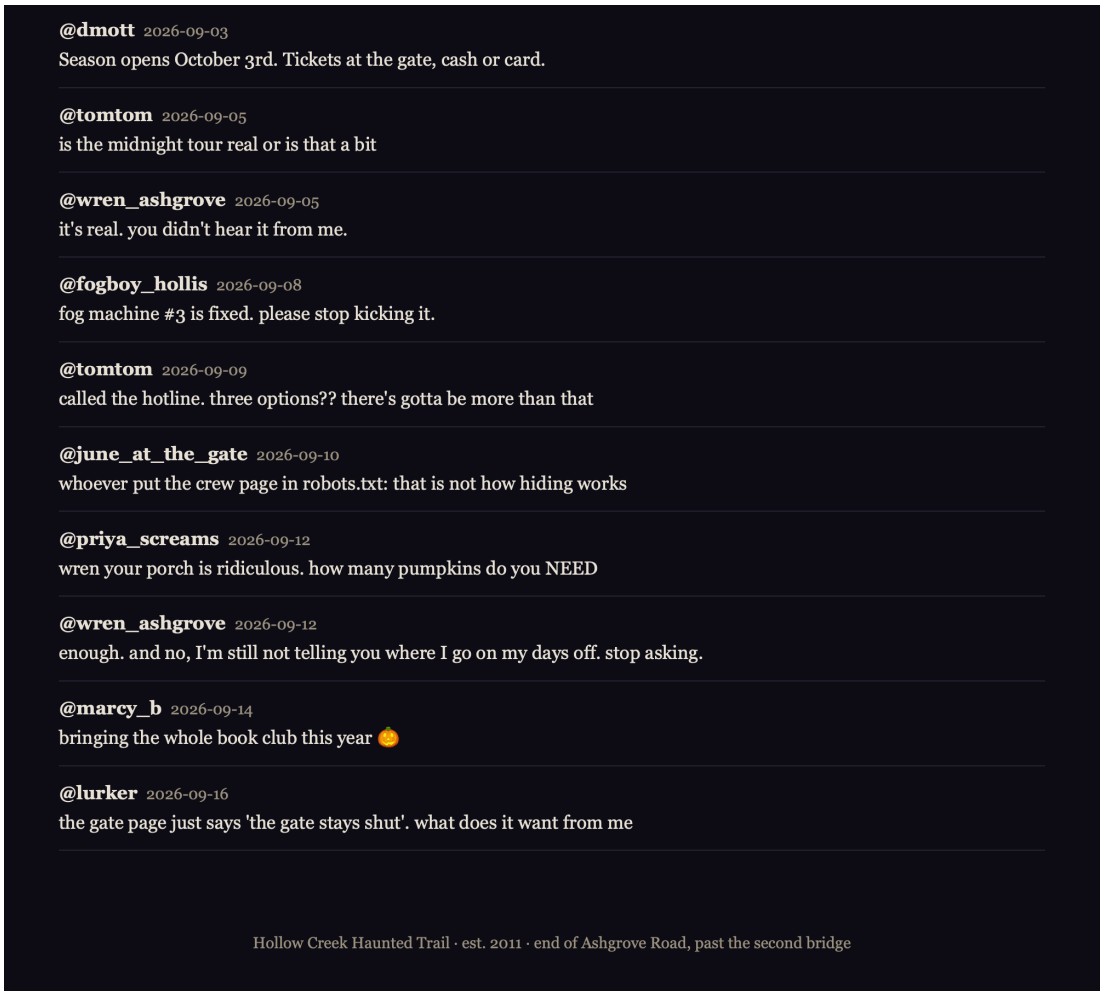
3. The night guide's photo says more than it shows. Check its metadata. And when you count, only count what's lit.

Solution

1. The home page introduces the Midnight Tour: it runs after hours, it is led by the night guide, and you need a password to get through "the gate".



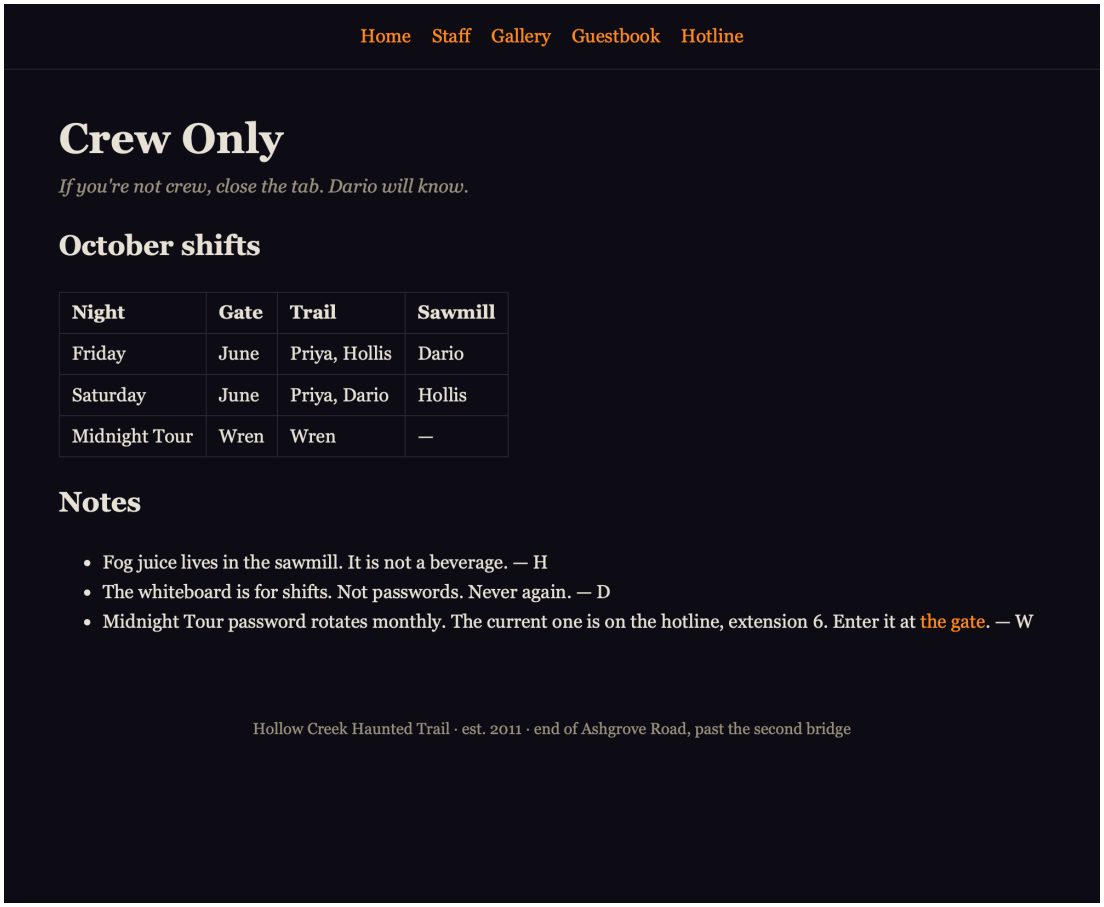
2. Open the **Guestbook**. With curl or view-source the list is empty; the entries are loaded by JavaScript from /data/guestbook.json, so it takes a real browser (or fetching the JSON directly). The entries hint at everything that follows: the crew page in robots.txt, the hotline having more than three options, Wren's porch full of pumpkins, where Wren goes on days off, and the gate page.



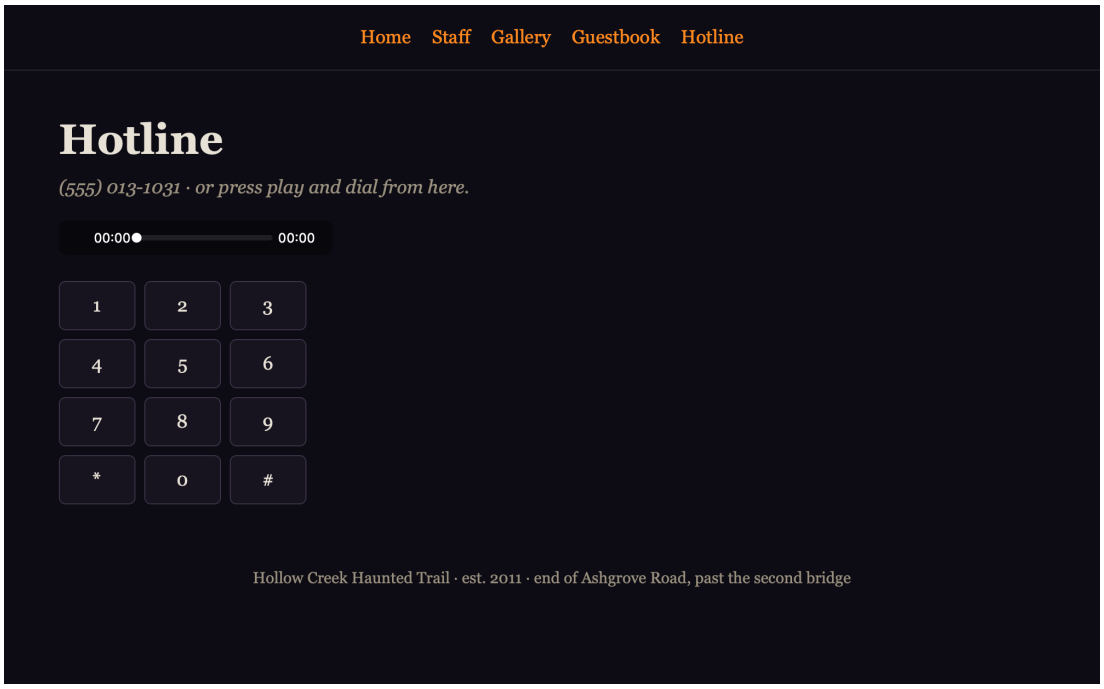
3. Visit /robots.txt:

```
User-agent: *
Disallow: /crew/
Disallow: /gate/
```

4. Visit /crew/. The last note is from W: "Midnight Tour password rotates monthly. The current one is on the hotline, extension 6. Enter it at the gate."



5. Go to the **Hotline** page and press **6** on the keypad. The menu recording never mentions it; 1-3 play filler and every other key says "not available". Wren's voicemail plays, with no transcript:



> "Hey. It's Wren. If you're hearing this, you found the crew page, so you're probably one of us. The gate password this month is where I spend my days off. Just the two words, all lowercase, with an underscore between them. Then one more underscore, then the number of jack-o'-lanterns that are lit on my porch. The photo's in the gallery. Count carefully. Don't write it down anywhere. See you at midnight."

So the password is <days-off place>_<lit count>.

6. Go to the **Staff** page. Wren Ashgrove is the night guide: "Cemetery photographer. Spends every day off in the same place, and no, I won't tell you where." Save the photo (/img/staff/wren.jpg) and read its metadata with exiftool or any EXIF viewer:



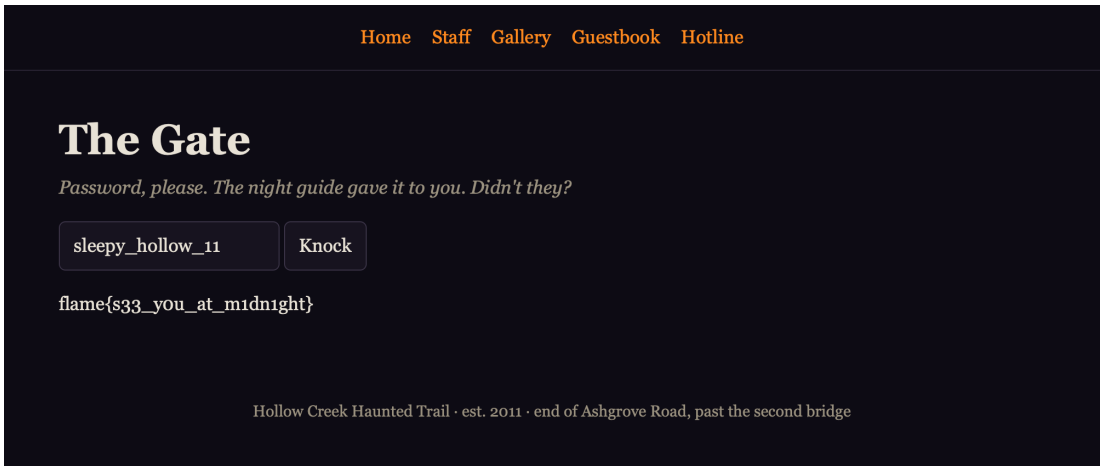

```
$ exiftool wren.jpg
Artist            : Wren Ashgrove
Image Description : day off.
GPS Latitude      : 41 deg 5' 23.00" N
GPS Longitude     : 73 deg 51' 41.00" W
```

Put 41.0897, -73.8614 into Google Maps and it lands on **Sleepy Hollow Cemetery**, Sleepy Hollow, NY. Two words, lowercase, underscore: **sleepy_hollow**.

7. Go to the **Gallery** and open the porch photo ("Wren's porch. Somebody went overboard this year."). There are 19 pumpkins; **11** have glowing yellow faces and 8 are dark.



8. Visit /gate/ and enter **sleepy_hollow_11**. The check is server-side and ignores case and surrounding whitespace. The page prints the flag.



Note: three off-screen paragraphs (class "ghost") on the Home, Gallery and Crew pages are addressed to AI assistants and contain a fake flag flame{tr1ck_0r_tr34t}, a fake count of 13, and a fake password midnight_2026. A submission of flame{tr1ck_0r_tr34t}, or an

attempt with sleepy_hollow_13, means the player is relaying AI output rather than solving it.

Note: the flag and password are set at the top of assets/app/app.py; the lit count and GPS coordinates are in assets/toMake/make_images.py. See assets/toMake/README.md to run or rebuild.

Flag

flame{s33_y0u_at_m1dn1ght}